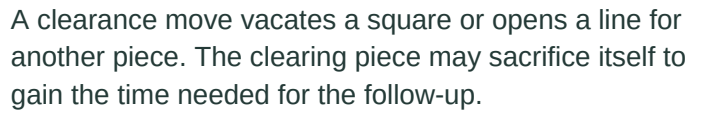


Clearance tactics

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES



Identify the rook, bishop, queen, or knight that needs access, then locate the friendly piece blocking its route or destination.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: queen on e3. Check for tactical protection.

Previous move: 23.Qe3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

23...Qxg3+ 24. hxg3 Rh1#

23...Qxg3+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. From g3 it attacks king on g1 and rook on f2. Recorded reply:
24.hxg3.

24...Rh1# Mate: rook on h1 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on g1. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on h1. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

Opening a line helps only if your next move is timely. The defender may close the line or create a stronger threat.